

IDEA9106 Design Thinking

Semester 2 2026

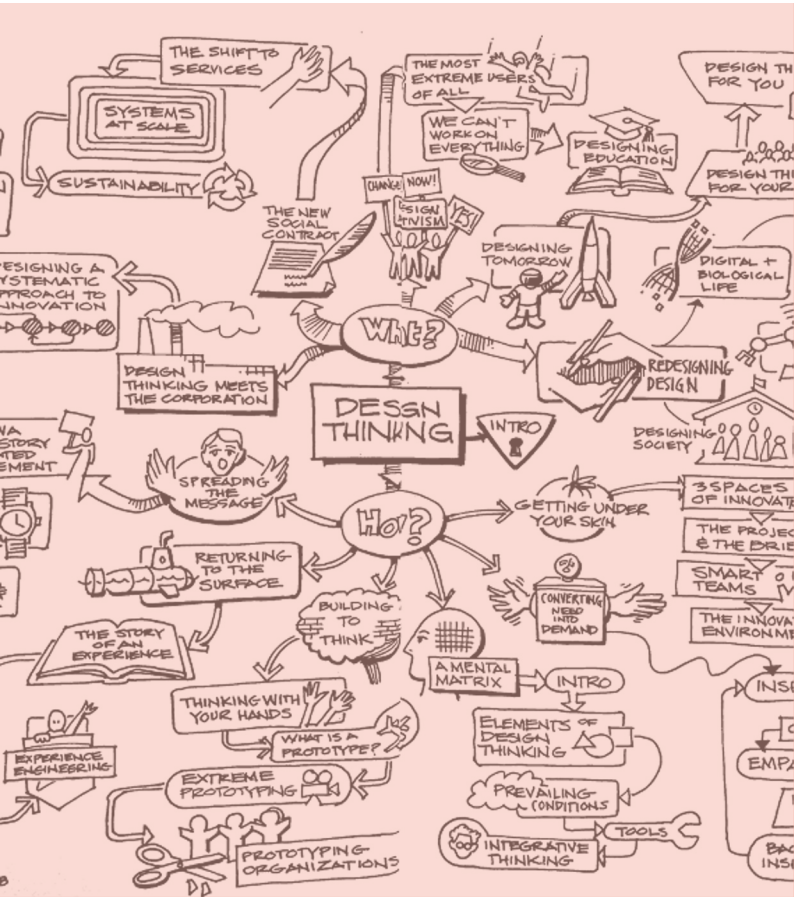


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We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities - past and present - of the lands upon which this University of Sydney campus sits. Indigenous knowledge has been generated and shared for thousands of years, underpinned by a strong connection to land, sea and culture. We seek to continue to exchange knowledge and build connections upon these traditions.



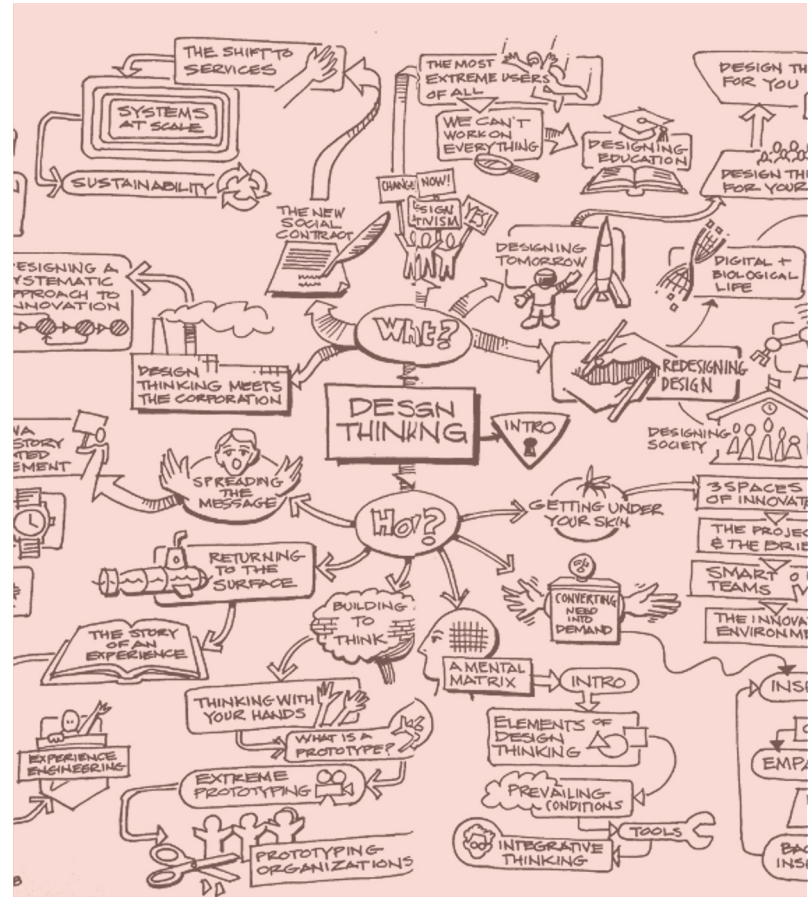


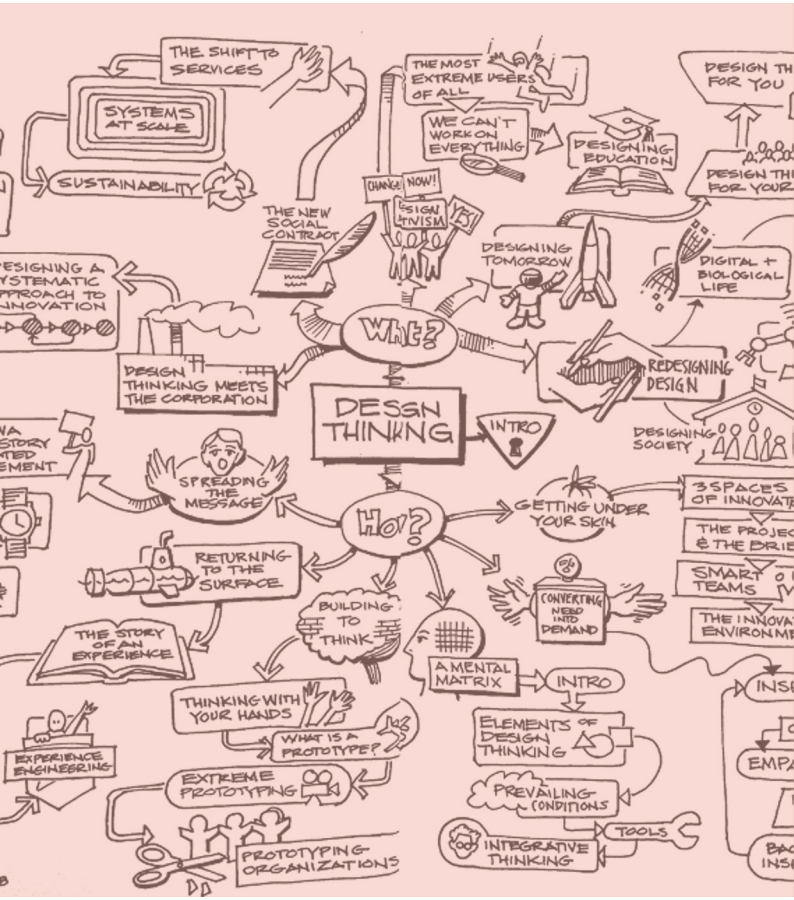
Tutorial Aim

In this tutorial students will:

- Complete A1c. Mindset task 2
- Create a shared context for the group project
- Apply insights from affinity diagramming
- Develop an evidence-based persona and reframed brief using individual and collective user insights

- A1c. Mindset task 2
- Creating shared context
- Personas
- Reframing the initial project brief
- Wrap up





Teacher Check-in



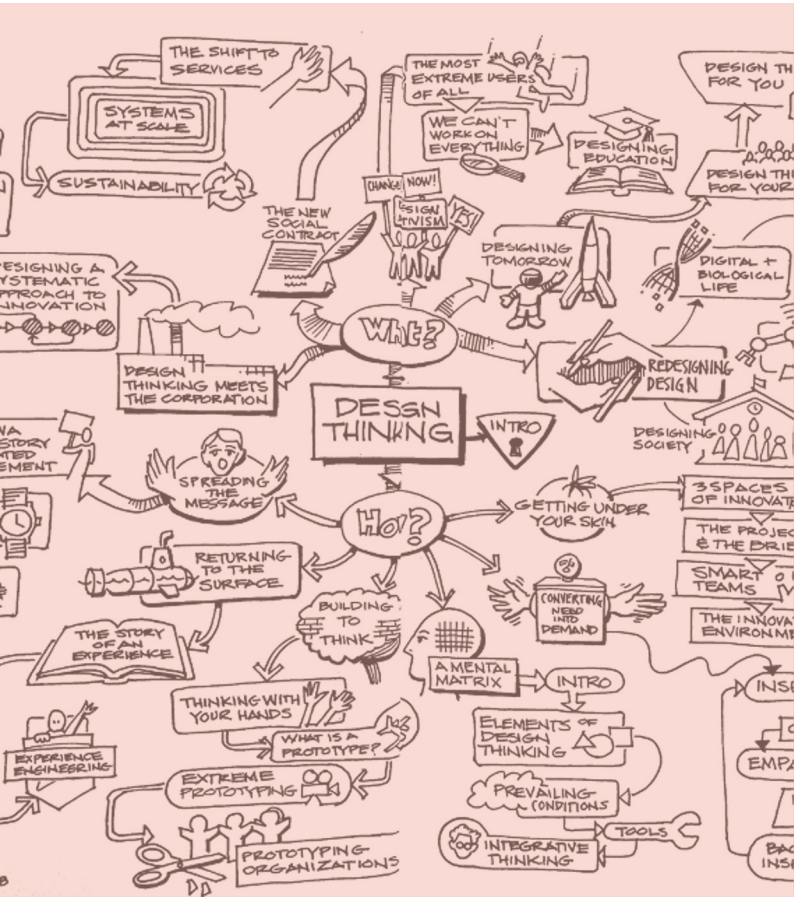


Shared Group Context (10 mins)

In your project groups:

- Each person: name the waiting situation you researched, in one sentence
- Look for what connects them: the same setting, the same kind of wait, or the same pressure
- Agree one waiting situation the group will take forward
- Name who waits in it, and who runs it

Nothing is discarded. A different wait still tells you about waiting.



Personas

This activity asks you to take the analysis insights from the affinity diagramming activities and develop an evidence-based persona.

Note: Please watch the second half of the recorded lecture if you did not attend or watch the lecture before tutorial.



Personas

- This week we will be taking the analysis insights from the affinity diagramming activities to develop an evidence-based persona.
- As introduced in the lecture, personas are fictional characters used to represent typical users, customers or other stakeholders.
- They are created from a synthesis of data from real people gathered through methods such as interviews.
- Each team member will develop a persona based on their individual affinity diagram insights.

Note: The brief asks you to consider at least two stakeholders.

You can develop personas for one or both of them.



Part 1: Identify variables (15 mins)

- read through your interview data (transcripts and affinity diagram pics)
- document the important variables on the Personas Data Sheet (Figma or PDF)

Variables can be behavioural, attitudinal or demographic:

- behavioural e.g. frequency, cost sensitivity, tech savviness etc.
- attitudinal e.g. likes/dislikes, trusts/mistrusts, emotions etc.
- demographic e.g. age, gender, dependents, job type, etc.



Part 2: Identify patterns (15 mins)

- Synthesise patterns in the data by looking for patterns or clusters across all the variables in your interview data.
- Patterns will manifest as similar behaviour across multiple people who share other characteristics. For example, interview data for a new study resource might reveal that students who plan their work in advance also have work and/or caring commitments.



Part 3: Create a persona (20 mins)

- Amalgamate each pattern in the data to form a single but coherent 'persona'. e.g. you may have found that 'students who plan their work in advance' are more likely to have more than one part-time job.
- Make each persona believable and engaging by using storytelling:
 - provide a name
 - photographic image (not icons, avatars or cartoons)
 - backstory.
- Use the persona creation template on Figma or PDF.



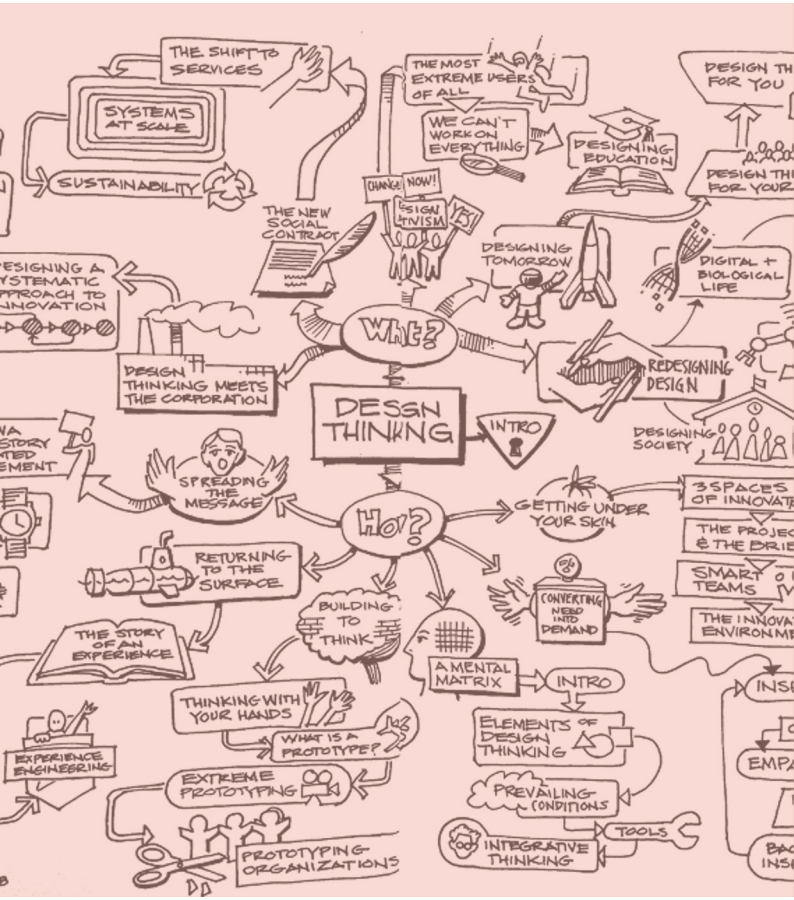
Part 4: Review and refine (15 mins)

In pairs, review each other's persona, discuss and provide constructive feedback, by:

- reading through the personas
- referring to the interview transcripts and/or affinity diagram for clarification, as needed

Helpful questions to guide discussion and feedback:

- How realistic, convincing and coherent is the persona? Why?
- Are the goals specific to the reframed brief/design problem/opportunity?



Reframing

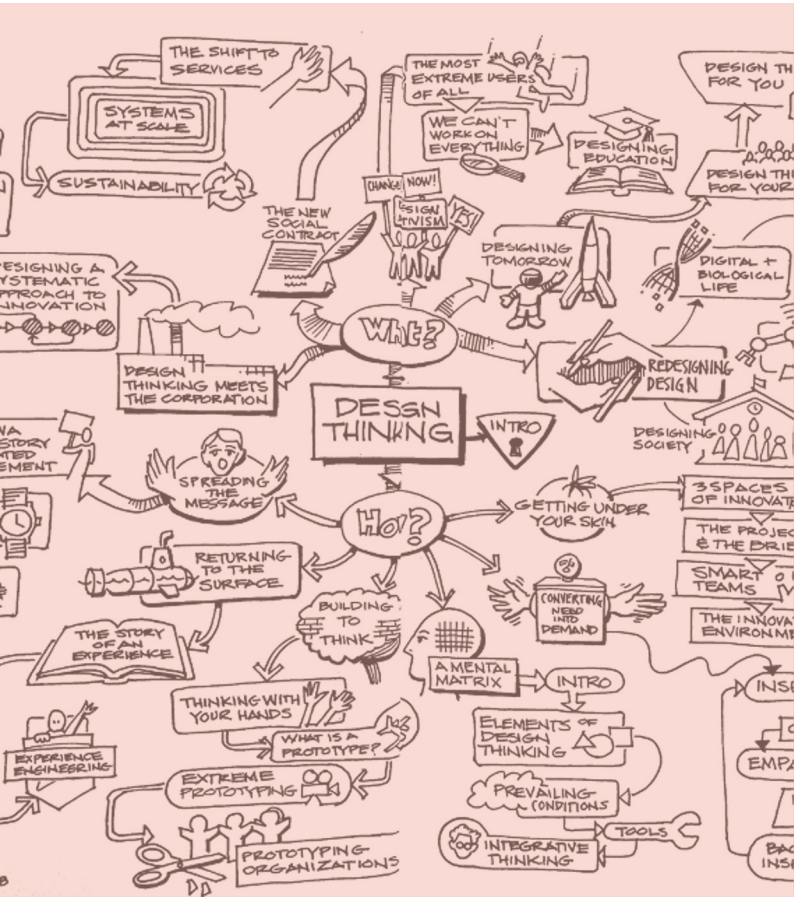
This activity provides an opportunity to reframe the initial design brief to align with the project group's analysis of interview data.



Reframing the Initial Project Brief (20 mins)

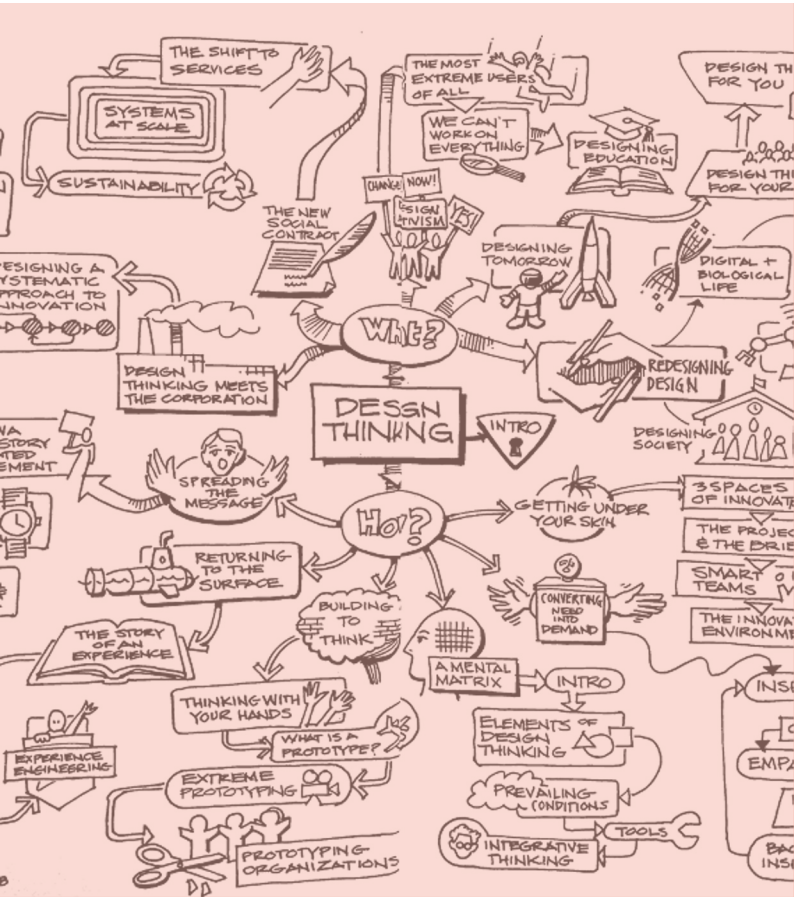
Working in your project groups, discuss the following questions:

- What **new insights** about our users/stakeholders and the problem/opportunity have emerged from the individual and project group's affinity diagram?
- Which of these new insights are relevant for reframing the initial design brief?
- Can you formulate a new '**How Might We**' question based on the project group's collective user insights?
- The brief asks you to consider at least two stakeholders. Your framing needs to consider both.



Wrap Up

- Any unexpected insights from today's tutorial?
- Anything that's still not clear or is confusing?
- Any questions or thoughts?



Before Week 7

As a project group:

- discuss potential opportunity spaces to take forward into the group project
- finalise the reframed brief
- formulate a Problem/Opportunity Statement for the reframed brief

See you next week!



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